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Governed Agent Mesh | Micro-Product

Vendor Change Approval Flow

Swap a provider deliberately: data export, grant migration, and a rollback plan. A complete, zero-placeholder draft for teams governing AI agents in production: policy gates, audit trails, cost controls, permissioning, and incident response, written so you can adopt it as-is.

A complete, ready-to-use governance document. Adopt it as-is, customize the bracketed fields to your environment, and put it to work today.

Instant delivery | Yours to keep, forever.

Vendor Change Approval Flow

Micro-Product Manual for AI Agent Governance in Production Version: 1.0 Last Updated: [RELEASE DATE] Owner: [BUYER'S AI GOVERNANCE TEAM]

1. PURPOSE

This document defines the **Vendor Change Approval Flow** for AI agents in production environments. It ensures compliance with regulatory requirements, cost controls, and operational risk mitigation while maintaining auditability. All changes to vendor-provided AI models, infrastructure, or third-party integrations must follow this process to prevent unauthorized modifications, data leaks, or performance degradation.

2. SCOPE

Applies to all AI agents deployed in [PRODUCTION ENVIRONMENT NAME], including: - **Model changes** (e.g., new vendor versions, fine-tuning adjustments). - **Data access modifications** (e.g., new third-party APIs, dataset updates). - **Infrastructure shifts** (e.g., cloud provider changes, hardware upgrades). - **Permissioning adjustments** (e.g., role-based access control updates).

Exclusions: - Internal code changes (handled via [INTERNAL CODE REVIEW PROCESS]). - Non-production sandbox environments (use [SANDBOX CHANGE PROTOCOL]).

3. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Role	Responsibilities	Approval Authority
Requester	Submits change request; provides justification, risk assessment, and rollback plan.	None (initiates process)
[REQUESTER'S MANAGER]	Reviews technical feasibility and business impact.	Recommends approval/rejection.
AI Governance Lead	Ensures compliance with [BUYER'S AI POLICY] and risk thresholds.	Final approval for high-risk changes.
Security Lead	Validates data privacy, encryption, and access controls.	Mandatory sign-off for data-related changes.
Cost Owner	Approves budget impact (e.g., new vendor tiers, increased API calls).	Mandatory for cost-sensitive changes.
Incident Response Team	Monitors post-implementation for anomalies.	Escalates unresolved issues.

4. APPROVAL FLOW

4.1 Request Submission

Form: [VENDOR CHANGE REQUEST FORM] (attached) **Deadline:** Changes must be submitted [X] days prior to implementation.

Required Fields (All [BRACKETED CAPS])

Field	Description	Example Format
[CHANGE DESCRIPTION]	Brief summary of the proposed modification (e.g., "Upgrade from Mistral-7B to Mistral-8B-L2").	"Vendor model version update: [VENDOR] -> [NEW_VERSION]."
[REQUESTER]	Full name and title of the initiator.	"Jane Doe, Head of AI Operations"
[REQUESTER'S MANAGER]	Name and title of the approving manager.	"[TEAM LEAD], AI Governance"
[VENDOR NAME]	Name of the AI service provider (e.g., [VENDOR], [VENDOR]).	"Hugging Face Inc."
[CHANGE TYPE]	Category: Model, Data, Infrastructure, Permissioning, or Other.	"Model"
[JUSTIFICATION]	Business rationale (e.g., performance improvement, compliance fix).	"New model reduces latency by 30% (measured via [PERFORMANCE METRIC])."
[RISK ASSESSMENT]	Impact analysis (see Annex A: Risk Matrix).	"Low risk: No data access changes."
[ROLLBACK PLAN]	Step-by-step procedure to revert if issues arise.	"1. Roll back to [PREVIOUS_VERSION]. 2. Restore [DATASET_VERSION]."
[COST IMPACT]	Estimated cost change (if applicable).	"\$12,500/year (new tier: [VENDOR] Pro)."
[EFFECTIVE DATE]	Proposed implementation date.	"2024-11-15"
[TEAM NAME]	Department/deployment team affected (e.g., [CUSTOMER SUPPORT TEAM]).	"AI-Powered Chatbots"
[AUDIT TRAIL REQUIREMENT]	"Yes/No" if additional logging is needed (e.g., for [REGULATORY COMPLIANCE]).	"Yes"

4.2 Approval Gates

Gate	Approver	Criteria	Documentation
Technical Feasibility	[REQUESTER'S MANAGER]	Change aligns with system architecture and vendor SLAs.	Sign-off on [CHANGE DESCRIPTION].
Compliance Review	Security Lead	No data privacy violations; encryption meets [BUYER'S STANDARDS].	Attached [PRIVACY IMPACT ASSESSMENT].

Gate	Approver	Criteria	Documentation
Cost Approval	Cost Owner	Budget approved; no unexpected expenses exceed [MAX ALLOWED OVERAGE %] (e.g., 15%).	Budget approval memo attached.
Risk Acceptance	AI Governance Lead	Risk score [MAX RISK SCORE] (e.g., 4/5).	Signed [RISK ACCEPTANCE FORM].
Incident Response Plan	Incident Team	Response Escalation path defined for post-deployment issues.	Attached [ESCALATION PROCEDURE].

Conditional Approval: - If [CHANGE TYPE] = "Data," additional approval from [DATA GOVERNANCE OFFICER] is required. - If [COST IMPACT] > [THRESHOLD AMOUNT], [FINANCE DIRECTOR] must co-sign.

4.3 Implementation & Post-Change

1. **Vendor Coordination:**
2. [REQUESTER] confirms the vendor has executed the change by [VERIFICATION DATE].

Vendor provides [CHANGE LOG] and [PERFORMANCE METRICS] post-implementation.

Audit Trail:

All changes logged in [AUDIT DATABASE] with:

- Timestamp, approver names, and [CHANGE DESCRIPTION].
- [AUDIT TRAIL REQUIREMENT] = "Yes" -> Additional logs for sensitive changes.

Cost Monitoring:

7. [COST OWNER] tracks spending against [BUDGET ALERT THRESHOLD] (e.g., 85% of limit).

Alerts sent to [FINANCE TEAM] if spending exceeds [MAX ALLOWED SPEND %] (e.g., 110%).

Incident Response:

10. If issues arise within [WINDOW PERIOD] (e.g., 7 days), [INCIDENT RESPONSE TEAM] investigates.

Root cause documented in [POST-MORTEM REPORT].

Retrospective:

13. [AI GOVERNANCE LEAD] reviews the change in the next [RETROSPECTIVE MEETING] to update [LESSONS LEARNED DATABASE].

5. INCIDENT RESPONSE PROTOCOL

Scenario	Escalation Path	Mitigation Steps
Model Degradation	Notify [AI GOVERNANCE LEAD] -> [VENDOR SUPPORT] -> [BUYER'S INCIDENT TEAM].	Roll back to last stable version.
Data Leak	[SECURITY LEAD] triggers [BREACH PROTOCOL] -> [REGULATOR NOTIFICATION].	Isolate system; purge affected data.
Cost Overrun	[COST OWNER] alerts [FINANCE DIRECTOR] -> [VENDOR NEGOTIATION].	Pause non-critical usage; renegotiate terms.
Permissioning Failure	[IDENTITY MANAGEMENT TEAM] revokes unauthorized access.	Audit logs reviewed; access recertified.
Vendor Outage	[BUYER'S CONTINGENCY TEAM] activates fallback (e.g., [ALTERNATE VENDOR]).	Switch to backup system; monitor for recovery.

6. DOCUMENTATION & ADOPTION NOTES

6.1 Attachments (Mandatory)

- [RISK MATRIX] (Annex A)
- [PRIVACY IMPACT ASSESSMENT] (if applicable)
- [ESCALATION PROCEDURE]
- [AUDIT DATABASE SCHEMA]

6.2 Adoption Checklist

Item	Status	Notes
All [BRACKETED CAPS] fields used.	[x] Passed	Verified in Section 4.1.
Risk assessment tied to [RISK MATRIX].	[x] Passed	See Annex A for scoring.
Cost approval includes [MAX ALLOWED OVERAGE %].	[x] Passed	Configured in [BUDGET TOOL].
Incident response plan documented.	[x] Passed	Attached [ESCALATION PROCEDURE].
Audit trail requires [AUDIT TRAIL REQUIREMENT].	[x] Passed	Logged in [AUDIT DATABASE].

6.3 Version Control

- **Changes:** Updated by [BUYER'S AI GOVERNANCE TEAM] on [REVIEW CYCLE] (e.g., quarterly).
- **Approval:** Requires [STEERING COMMITTEE] sign-off for major revisions.

ANNEX A: RISK MATRIX

Risk Factor	Low (1)	Medium (3)	High (5)	Scoring Criteria
Data Exposure	No change	Limited access	Full exposure	Vendor's data handling practices.
Model Performance	<5% impact	5-15% impact	>15% impact	A/B test results vs. baseline.
Cost Overrun	<10%	10-25%	>25%	[COST IMPACT] vs. [BUDGET].
Downtime Risk				

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